

not sealed;

(4) The proposed sealing is narrowly tailored; and

(5) No less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest.

See CRC Rule 2.550(d)(1)-(5).

The law favors maximum public access to judicial proceedings and court records. *Alfaro v. Superior Court* (2020) 58 Cal.App.5th 371, 386, quoting *Pantos v. City and County of San Francisco* (1984) 151 Cal.App.3d 258, 262-63. “Judicial records are historically and presumptively open to the public and there is an important right of access which should not be closed except for **compelling** countervailing reasons.” *Id.* (emphasis added).

The supporting declaration describes that the moving parties only seek to seal certain very specific portions of the subject pleadings. See Declaration of Pat Lundvall, ¶¶3-5.

The unredacted versions of both pleadings were lodged for the Court’s review. The redacted materials are represented to include confidential information that presents a risk of serious personal or other injury to the parties to this action and other third parties if disclosed publicly. *Id.* at ¶3. The Portions to be Sealed appear narrowly tailored.

Accordingly, the Court finds that there exists an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the specific Portions to be Sealed. The Court further finds that this overriding interest supports sealing the Portions to be Sealed and there exists a substantial probability that the overriding interest will be prejudiced if the Portions to be Sealed are not sealed. Subject to resolution of the issue discussed below, the Court further finds that the Portions to be Sealed are narrowly tailored and that there is no less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest.

Disposition

The Court finds and orders as follows:

1. The Motion to Seal is GRANTED. The Court orders the sealing of Portions to be Sealed that were filed provisionally under seal.
2. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

6. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02652

CASE NAME: AMERICAN EXPRESS NATIONAL BANK VS. MOHAMMED AZAM

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: VACATE THE CONDITIONAL DISMISSAL AND ENTRY OF JUDGMENT
CCP 664.6**

FILED BY: AMERICAN EXPRESS NATIONAL BANK

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff American Express National Bank (“Plaintiff”) filed a Motion to Vacate the Conditional Dismissal and for Entry of Judgment on January 13, 2026 (“Motion to Enforce Settlement”). The Motion to Enforce Settlement was set for hearing on March 30, 2025. The motion is unopposed.

Background

The parties entered into that certain settlement agreement filed November 22, 2024 (the “Settlement Agreement”), the terms of which included payment by the defendants MOHAMMED AZAM A/K/A MOHAMMED E AZAM and LOTUS ORGANIC LLC (“Defendants”) in the amount of \$73,707.02, to be paid

in accordance with the terms thereof (the "Payment Terms and Conditions"). See Declaration of Scott D. Dyle filed January 13, 2026 ("Supporting Declaration"), ¶¶3-5 and **Exhibit A** (Settlement Agreement) thereto.

As part of the Settlement Agreement, the parties entered into a stipulation for entry of judgment in the event of a default. Settlement Agreement, ¶¶5 and 12-13, Supporting Declaration, **Exhibit A**.

Defendants defaulted on the Payment Terms and Conditions. See Supporting Declaration, ¶7. Defendant failed to cure after notice. *Id.* at ¶¶8-9 and **Exhibit B** thereto.

After credit for amounts paid, there remains \$68,707.02 due and owing, plus costs of \$655.00. See Supporting Declaration, ¶10.

Analysis

Defendants were duly served with the motion. The motion is unopposed.

The Settlement Agreement includes a provision that it is enforceable pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 664.6 and jurisdiction was reserved by the Court for that purpose. Settlement Agreement, ¶13 and Order thereon, Supporting Declaration, **Exhibit A**.

Disposition

The Court finds and orders as follows:

1. The Court finds that Defendants were duly served with the motion.
2. The Court finds that Defendants are in default of the Settlement Agreement.
3. The Motion to Enforce Settlement is GRANTED. Plaintiff shall have judgment against Defendants in the principal amount of \$68,707.02 plus costs of \$655.00, for a total judgment of \$69,362.02.
4. Plaintiff's submitted form of order and/or money judgment against Defendants will be entered by the Court. Any prior dismissal entered herein as to the Defendants is hereby set aside in connection with entry of such judgment.
- 5.

7. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-03520

CASE NAME: MARNA PAINTSIL ANNING VS. WILDWOOD AT VILLAGE PARK OWNERS' ASSOCIATION

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: REASONABLE ATTORNEYS' FEES AND COSTS**

FILED BY: WILDWOOD AT VILLAGE PARK OWNERS' ASSOCIATION

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendant Wildwood at Village Park Owners' Association ("Defendant") filed a Motion for Reasonable Attorneys' Fees and Costs on November 14, 2025 (the "Motion for Fees and Costs"). The Motion for Fees and Costs was set for hearing on March 30, 2025. The motion is opposed.

Background

Following the sustaining of Defendant's demurrer to Plaintiff Marna Paintsil Anning's ("Plaintiff") Complaint without leave to amend, the Court entered judgment in favor of Defendant and found Defendant to be the prevailing party. See Judgment for Dismissal